Informed Consent to Participate in a Research Interview

Study title	Luxury Resort Traveler Depth Interviews
Institution	USC Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism, University of Southern California
Course	DSM 550: Analytic Research and Methodology
Course instructor	Professor Rafael Bracero
Researchers	DSM 550 student research team (5 members)

1. Purpose of the Study

You are invited to participate in a research interview conducted by master's students at the USC Annenberg School for Communication and Journalism. This study is part of the course DSM 550: Analytic Research and Methodology, taught by Professor Rafael Bracero. The purpose of the study is to understand how travelers choose and experience luxury resort vacations. The findings will be used solely for academic coursework.

2. Procedures

If you agree to participate, you will take part in one semi-structured interview lasting approximately 30 minutes, either in person or via Zoom. You will be asked about your travel experiences and preferences, and you will be shown a small number of images, guest review excerpts, and advertising concepts for your reaction. There are no right or wrong answers.

3. Information Collected

With your permission, the research team will collect the following information:

- Your first name
- Your email address and phone number, collected as required by the course instructor and used only for course purposes, scheduling the interview, and delivering your thank-you gift card
- General travel information you choose to share, such as who you usually travel with
- An audio recording of the interview (and a video recording if the interview takes place on Zoom)
- Written notes taken by the interviewer

4. Confidentiality and Data Protection

The research team will take the following steps to protect your information:

- Your information will be used **only for this course project** and for no other purpose.
- Access to recordings, notes, and contact details will be limited to the five members of the student research team and the course instructor, Professor Rafael Bracero.

- Your personal information, including your name, email address, and phone number, **will not be shared, sold, or disclosed** to any third party, including any resort, hotel, or company.
- All files will be stored in password-protected accounts accessible only to the research team.
- Any quotations used in class presentations or reports will be **anonymized** and will not include your name or any detail that could reasonably identify you.

5. Data Retention and Destruction

All audio and video recordings, interview notes, and personal information, including your email address and phone number, will be **permanently deleted on December 3, 2026**. No copies will be kept after that date.

6. Risks and Benefits

There are no known risks associated with this study beyond those of everyday conversation. You will not receive any direct benefit from participating, but your responses will help the research team complete its academic coursework.

7. Voluntary Participation and Withdrawal

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You may decline to answer any question, pause, or end the interview at any time without penalty and without giving a reason. You may also request that your information be deleted at any time before December 3, 2026 by contacting the research team.

8. Compensation

In appreciation of your time, you will receive a $10 Starbucks gift card, delivered to the email address you provide within 5 days of the interview. You will receive the gift card even if you choose to end the interview early.

9. Contact Information

If you have questions about this study, please contact the research team or the course instructor, Professor Rafael Bracero.

10. Statement of Consent

By signing below, I confirm that:

- I have read and understood the information in this form.
- I have had the opportunity to ask questions, and my questions have been answered.
- I agree to the collection of my first name, email address, phone number, and interview responses as described above.
- I understand that my personal information will not be disclosed and will be permanently deleted on December 3, 2026.
- I voluntarily agree to participate in this interview.

Please initial each item:

_____ I consent to the interview being audio-recorded (and video-recorded if held on Zoom).

_____ I consent to the use of anonymized quotations in class presentations and reports.

Participant

First name: _____

Email address: _____

Phone number: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Researcher

Name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Please keep a copy of this form for your records.